Calgary, AB
July 15, 2025

To Whom It May Concern,

It is with pleasure that I write this letter recommending Joel Amaldas. I have known Joel for over one year, being his High School programming teacher and lead mentor for his FIRST Robotics Competition (FRC) 9277 team. I have witnessed Joel's inquiry and excellence in research and innovation as he follows the Engineering Design Process to methodically help his team to problem-solve. As a grade 10 student, Joel took tremendous leadership in school-wide group efforts. I was also impressed by Joel's ability to work under pressure to troubleshoot robots, being rational and precise to ensure there were no loose connections and test that the robot's code was functional.

Joel is a role model for youth in STEM, and he often participates in outreach activities teaching FIRST Lego robotics to community children, and sharing his passion for robotics. I have witnessed Joel's growth, and his willingness to take calculated risks, not being afraid of failure. He has taken leadership in our school's Samsung Solve for Tomorrow competition team, by recruiting a team of students to work with him in drafting the proposal and to design, build and code, a robotic wheelchair operated using face muscles and eye tracking. Joel was pivotal in coding the Muse Headband to read eyebrow movement to confirm the location the user would like to move to. Joel's team secured second place in the prestigious Samsung Solve for Tomorrow competition with over 90 Canadian participating schools.

Joel's greatest quality is his strong work ethic and his vision that allow him to grow as he works towards his goals. He has built excellent relationships with teachers and FRC industry mentors, driven by his inquiry and interest in learning. Beyond robotics and programming, he excels in science. Joel participated in the Canada Wide science fair, having received a gold medal, the Pfizer Oncology Science Award, and the Spartan Controls Innovation and Computer Science Award at the Calgary Youth Science fair.

Joel is a pleasure to work with, and I am confident that his curiosity, growth mindset, and work ethic makes him an outstanding candidate and an asset to your organization. Joel will learn and work alongside community members towards a common goal, as he continues to solve problems, positively impacting his community.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any questions.

Sincerely,



Laura Roa, P.Eng (she/her)
Teacher – Mechatronics and Programming
Lead Mentor – FRC 10384 Sparkans Robotics
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